5.11 Spinal Cord Injury*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I cannot feel or move my legs." **Objective** • Paraplegia • No sensation below T10	**ACTUAL** Impaired physical mobility related to spinal cord injury as evidenced by inability to move the lower limbs.	• Spine kept aligned and complications of immobility prevented.	• Maintain spinal alignment; log-roll as ordered. • Carry out ROM exercises. • Turn every 2 hours. • Begin rehabilitation.	• Considered met if there are no contractures or pressure injuries.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • No bladder control • Distended bladder	**ACTUAL** Impaired urinary elimination related to neurogenic bladder as evidenced by urinary retention.	• Bladder emptied regularly without infection.	• Perform intermittent catheterization as ordered. • Record output. • Start bladder training.	• Goal reached when emptying is regular.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Immobile • Sensory loss	**RISK** Risk for adult pressure injury as evidenced by risk factors: immobility and sensory loss.	• Skin intact.	• Inspect the skin at least twice daily, particularly sacrum and heels. • Use a pressure-redistributing mattress. • Turn every 2 hours. • Teach pressure-relief lifts in the wheelchair.	• Met while the skin remains intact.

*References for this care plan: [19], [35], [37], [128]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.